st. People make a few small changes, fail to see a tangible result, and cide to stop. You think, "I've been running every day for a month, so ıy can't I see any change in my body?" Once this kind of thinking kes over, it's easy to let good habits fall by the wayside. But in order make a meaningful difference, habits need to persist long enough to eak through this plateau—what I call the *Plateau of Latent otential.*

If you find yourself struggling to build a good habit or break a bad e, it is not because you have lost your ability to improve. It is often cause you have not yet crossed the Plateau of Latent Potential. ɔmplaining about not achieving success despite working hard is like mplaining about an ice cube not melting when you heated it from enty-five to thirty-one degrees. Your work was not wasted; it is just ing stored. All the action happens at thirty-two degrees.

When you finally break through the Plateau of Latent Potential, ople will call it an overnight success. The outside world only sees the ɔst dramatic event rather than all that preceded it. But you know at it's the work you did long ago—when it seemed that you weren't aking any progress—that makes the jump today possible.

It is the human equivalent of geological pressure. Two tectonic ates can grind against one another for millions of years, the tension ɔwly building all the while. Then, one day, they rub each other once ain, in the same fashion they have for ages, but this time the tension too great. An earthquake erupts. Change can take years—before it ppens all at once.

Mastery requires patience. The San Antonio Spurs, one of the most ccessful teams in NBA history, have a quote from social reformer cob Riis hanging in their locker room: "When nothing seems to help, o and look at the stonecutter hammering away at his rock, perhaps a ndred times without as much as a crack showing in it. Yet at the ndred and first blow it will split in two, and I know it was not that ɔw that did it—but all that had gone before."

**THE PLATEAU OF LATENT POTENTIAL**

# ATOMIC HABITS

An Easy & Proven Way
to Build Good Habits &
Break Bad Ones

JAMES CLEAR

## Tiny Changes, Remarkable Results

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